

Otis T. Carr and the OTC-X1

The record, the machine, and the physics — a documentary and engineering audit of the 1957–61 "circular-foil spacecraft," written so a drone company can spend exactly zero dollars re-learning it.

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What this paper is. Otis Carr (1904–1982) is the most-cited American "flying saucer inventor" of the 1950s, and his machine keeps resurfacing — most recently in a 2021 General Science Journal paper (Gobbi, "Carr Technology") that reads his 1959 amusement-ride patent as a complete spacecraft schematic and derives 10^{13} W of free power from it. This paper does three things. **Part I** reconstructs what is *documented* about Carr from the patent, the court record, and dated press — and separates it cleanly from the legend that accreted after 2006. **Part II** describes the machine as Carr described it, faithfully. **Part III** prices every load-bearing claim against textbook physics with the original numbers, and identifies the two small residues that are real. The register is the same as the companion field guide: no claim without a tag; the anti-reflex guardrail (never dismiss a fringe claim without doing the arithmetic) applied in full — and, in this case, the arithmetic and the paperwork both close.

Tags used: **DOCUMENTED** (contemporary record — patent, court, dated press — or multiply corroborated) · **SINGLE-SOURCE** (one witness or one derivative source) · **LEGEND** (later, uncorroborated, or contradicted by the record) · **DERIVED** (follows from stated physics; arithmetic shown) · **REFUTED / PRICED** (fails on its own numbers) · **RESIDUE** (a real thread worth keeping).

How this paper handles energy claims — from first principles, not from "known physics." Energy bookkeeping over *device* + *reservoir* is an identity, not a law of nature that a new device might repeal; the only physical content of "conservation" is *which reservoir*. So no self-powering claim is dismissed here as "forbidden." Each is put through the same three questions this project uses across its energy lane ([zero_point_energy.html](#) §7, [the_vta.html](#)): (1) is a reservoir *named*? (2) when named, what does the coupling *price* to? (3) does the device show the *thermal sign* its reservoir implies — a heat engine cools its hot side and names a colder body; an artifact warms. One correction the network has since made:

the vacuum's zero-point floor is not a reservoir at all. It is passive and cancels from every net flow of heat (fluctuation–dissipation; Puthoff 1987), and the energy lane's measured nanometre-gap current (Moddel-class cells, $\sim 70 \text{ W/m}^2$, output $\propto 1/d$) is a static device with an open source. The Utron is judged against that standard, not against a prohibition: where Carr named his reservoir (atmospheric electricity) it prices to picowatts; where he named "free-space energy" he named no coupling, ran no thermal test, and his one public bench run drew all its power from an external motor. That is *unpriced and unshown*, which is a weaker verdict than "forbidden" and the correct one.

PART I — THE RECORD

1. Who Otis Carr was, in dated facts

Otis T. Carr was born 7 December 1904 in Elkins, West Virginia, and died 20 September 1982 in a Pittsburgh hospital of pneumonia and renal failure; he is buried in Allegheny Cemetery. In the 1942 census he was a night clerk at the Southern Hotel, Baltimore. **DOCUMENTED** (SSDI; *Pittsburgh Press*, 21 Sept 1982; Find-a-Grave 122223228). The widely repeated "died in Gardnerville, Nevada, in 2005" is false.

LEGEND

The documented arc of the OTC-X1 episode fits on one page:

Date	Event	Status
Mar 1952 (written) / 1958 (published)	<i>Dimensions of Mystery</i> , a mystical allegory (the Sphinx speaks to five-year-old Carr in 1909). Concepts copyrighted 1958: "Carrotto Gravity Motor," "Utron Electrical Battery," "OTC-X1."	DOCUMENTED
1 Aug 1955	Trademark filing "Carrotto." OTC Enterprises Inc. (Baltimore) sells stock from 18 Nov 1955.	DOCUMENTED
Jun 1957	Norman Evans Colton — ex-editor of the Army's <i>PS</i> magazine, previously FBI-investigated for fraud (not prosecuted) — joins as brochure editor, becomes "Director of Sales and Engineering" and Carr's public voice.	DOCUMENTED

28 Oct 1957	Press conference; AP national story. Army inspects the model 16 Dec 1957 and declines ("does not meet present or foreseeable needs").	DOCUMENTED
Apr–Nov 1958	Multiple appearances on Long John Nebel's <i>WOR Party Line</i> (19 Apr, 28 Jun, 11 Jul, 15 Nov). OTC-X1 model plans sold Oct 1958 at "\$5, two for \$9, three for \$12." <i>FATE</i> , "Gravity Machine?", May 1958 p.17.	DOCUMENTED
23 Nov 1958	Frontier City (Oklahoma City) manager James Burge invests \$32,800 (21,000 shares) + \$10,000 for a 45-ft "Educational Space Ride" — 35 passengers, counter-rotating shells, hydraulic lift.	DOCUMENTED
22 Jan 1959	Patent application filed (Ser. 788,392).	DOCUMENTED
Sun 19 Apr 1959	Demo day. The 6-ft × 4-ft, ~600-lb (272 kg) prototype, built by Aircraftsmen Inc., is to fly at 3 PM from a gravel pit to 400–600 ft before ~3,000 people. Postponement announced 2½ h late ("technical difficulties" / a bearing housing "off one-sixteenth of an inch"). Carr is in Mercy Hospital, Room 302 (per aide Aho, a "lung hemorrhage... from over-work and strain").	DOCUMENTED
Mon 20 Apr 1959	Bench test with an <i>external</i> drive motor, filmed by WKY-TV: "mercury then leaked from the innards of the machine, and the plastic halves began to come apart from the vibration" (Walter McGraw, <i>NBC Monitor</i>). Engineer Eugene Carini (2001): the two aluminium halves formed a capacitor that "would be a dead short to the batteries."	DOCUMENTED
28 May – 5 Jun 1959	SEC complaint → permanent injunction against OTC stock sales. Investigator's figures: ~\$150,000 raised in Baltimore; \$61,007 from >400 people 11 Mar 1958–7 Feb 1959; \$34,997 deposited in Oklahoma. Carr "took the fifth amendment 84 times."	DOCUMENTED
Aug 1959	<i>FATE</i> , "The Saucer That Didn't Fly," W.E. Du Soir, p.32.	DOCUMENTED
10 Nov 1959	US Patent 2,912,244, "Amusement Device," granted. Nine claims. See §2.	DOCUMENTED
19 Nov 1959	One-day jury trial (Okla. Co. Dist. Ct., Judge Clarence Mills), single count: selling 100 unregistered shares to	DOCUMENTED

	Gurney Warnberg of Yukon. Guilty in <40 min; jury assesses the statutory-maximum \$5,000 fine , no prison term. Affirmed <i>Carr v. State</i> , 1961 OK CR 15, 359 P.2d 606 (11 Jan 1961).	
11 Aug 1960	NY Attorney General Lefkowitz press release: investigating "space age charlatans" who "victimized investors of more than \$50,000" in OTC stock; subpoena for Carr and Colton (26 Sept 1960). An investigation, not a fine.	DOCUMENTED
Jan 1961	<i>True</i> magazine, "King of the Non-Flying Saucers" (Gehman). Nebel's <i>The Way Out World</i> devotes a chapter to Carr's "\$20,000,000 ticket to the moon."	DOCUMENTED
14 Jul 1961 – 17 Jan 1962	Jailed for non-payment of the fine, "serving it out at \$1 a day"; released after the six-month maximum / pauper's oath. (Wikipedia's "14-year sentence" is a garble of his lawyer's "5,000 days at a dollar a day.")	DOCUMENTED
1963–67	Homestead, PA "power gain machine" demos; a five-witness notarised statement (23 Nov 1963) later disavowed in writing by engineer-witness Milton Palkowitz. Half-scale wooden model shown to Dept. of Interior 1967. No patent ever issued on any power-gain device.	DOCUMENTED

Primary compilations: Curt Collins, *The Saucers That Time Forgot*, "The Life and Legend of Otis T. Carr," Parts 1–4 (2020–21), built on dated newspaper citations, the SEC/court record, and Lance Moody's 2001 interviews with six OTC participants; Kenneth Arnold, *Joyland, Aliens and the Men in Black Behind Otis T. Carr's Flying Saucer* (2021, document compilation incl. FBI files); the rexresearch.com Carr file (transcripts and brochures). Full list in References.

2. The patent, read as a patent

US 2,912,244 is the single primary technical document Carr left. It is worth quoting its own statement of purpose, because the entire post-2006 literature rests on the premise that it is a disguised spacecraft:

"...a novel amusement device having the overall configuration of a space craft and being formed in various sections, with portions of the sections being rotated in opposite directions to give the impression of movement to the passengers." Claim 1: "In an amusement device simulating a space ride, the combination of: an outer tubular shell..." — passengers receive "the impression of flying in an interplanetary space craft" via counter-rotating shells, minor vertical displacement on hydraulic jacks, and a projected film of "heavenly bodies" on an overhead screen.

Prior art cited: US 754,532 (1904), 868,369 (1907), 981,672 (1911), 1,818,647 (a merry-go-round, 1931). It has since been cited by amusement-ride patents (e.g. US 6,220,171, Universal Studios, 2001). It contains no propulsion claim, no energy claim, no electrical schematic, and no Utron. The Frontier City ride it describes was actually built and opened in 1959. **DOCUMENTED**

The claim that Carr "decided to patent his invention as if it were an educational and recreational device" to hide it (Gobbi 2021 §1; Project Camelot) has no support inside the document and is contradicted by Carr's own behaviour: in January 1960 he mailed supporters a photostat of the *Official Gazette* page as if the amusement patent validated the spacecraft (*True*, Jan 1961). **LEGEND**

3. The Tesla connection

Carr's own account, first aired on *Party Line* on 19 April 1958: he met Tesla in summer 1925 while a package clerk at a New York hotel; Tesla nicknamed him "the sponge." Retellings place this at the Hotel New Yorker, which opened in 1930 and housed Tesla only 1934–43 — an anachronism; the 1925-consistent hotel is the Pennsylvania. Gobbi's version ("over a period of three years... began his investigations in 1937") is a third, incompatible telling. On 28 June 1958, asked on air to name a single Tesla discovery, Carr answered: "That's funny — I cannot remember even one." Jim Murray, who visited Carr in the 1970s, came away "uncertain if the two had ever met." No contemporary document links them. **LEGEND** (Carr's claim, self-undermined)

4. The Ralph Ring testimony

The version of Carr that circulates today is almost entirely Ralph Ring's — given to Project Camelot (Kerry Cassidy, Las Vegas, August 2006; Ring aged 71), forty-five years after the events. Its load-bearing claims:

"Fly is not the right word. It traversed distance. It seemed to take no time. I was with two other engineers when we piloted the 45' craft about ten miles... we had returned with samples of rocks and plants from our destination... It was more like a kind of teleportation." — "We felt we were in the craft about fifteen or twenty minutes. We were told afterwards that we'd been carefully timed as... no longer than three or four minutes." — "...the metal turned to Jell-o. You could push your finger right into it." — the lab was "forcibly shut down by government agents" two weeks later (1961), "all files and documentation confiscated." — "We went into a kind of meditative state and all three of us focused our intentions on the effect we wanted to achieve."

Applied against the record:

- The only 45-ft object OTC ever built was the Frontier City ride, which had no power plant and did not leave its foundation. The one flight-intended article was the 6-ft prototype, which never flew and ended up bolted to a billboard outside Carr's Apple Valley, CA shop (leased 12 April 1960); by Carini's account it was later stolen off the billboard and stored in a barn in Dike, Iowa. **DOCUMENTED** / **SINGLE-SOURCE** (barn)
- No raid appears in the press, SEC, court, or FBI material assembled by Collins and Moody. In 1961 Carr was in Oklahoma serving out his fine, having first gone to Vashon Island, WA to avoid it.
- Rexresearch's editor reports that Ring told *him* he had "flown in a short test flight of a small model of the craft" — a different story from the 45-ft, ten-mile account. Ring's own 2012–16 "pod" replication programme (Blue Star Enterprise; UK/California/Australia builds) reports hand-spun counter-rotating models with "no voltage... no lift data"; a 2016 write-up concedes "there are not any real test results," citing hearsay of "35 to 40 volts" from a pod utron.
- No second crew member has ever been named or come forward. Camelot's framing page also gives the demo date as 15 April (it was the 19th), the NY action as a "January 1961 \$50,000 fine" (it was an August 1960 subpoena), and Carr's death as 2005 in Nevada (1982, Pittsburgh).

Verdict on the testimony: a single witness, first speaking after 45 years, whose central object did not exist, whose retellings differ, whose own replication attempts produced nothing, embedded in a page with four checkable errors of fact. The "consciousness-melds-with-engineering" element is by Ring's own statement not writable into equations, i.e. not testable. **LEGEND**

On suppression. This project adopts, as private frame, the thesis that some exotic-propulsion work has been suppressed. That frame does not license reading *every* failed inventor as a suppressed one, and Carr is a poor poster child for it: the file is unusually thick and points the other way. The prototype failed on a bench, in front of a television camera, with an *external* motor turning it, by leaking its mercury and vibrating apart. The government action was a public securities trial for selling unregistered stock, with a jury, an appeal, and a published opinion — not a seizure. If suppression needs evidence, it must be found elsewhere; citing Carr weakens the case.

PART II — THE MACHINE, AS CARR DESCRIBED IT

5. The OTC-X1 architecture

Faithfully rendered from the Nebel transcripts, the 1957–58 OTC brochures, and Gobbi's reading of the patent figures (which, for the *mechanical* layout of the ride, is fair):

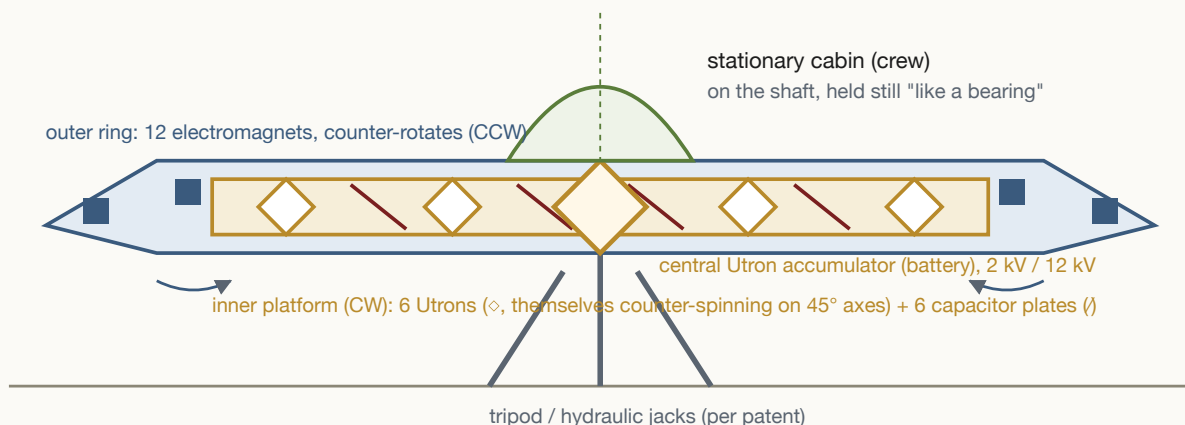


Figure 1 — The OTC-X1 as described: three concentric bodies on one shaft. Inner platform (clockwise) carrying the central Utron "accumulator," six peripheral Utrons and six capacitor plates; outer ring (counter-clockwise) carrying twelve electromagnets; cabin stationary between them. Layout after US 2,912,244 Figs. 2, 5, 6 and the Nebel transcripts. This is a faithful rendering of the claim, not an endorsement of any function.

The bodies. (1) An inner platform rotating clockwise, carrying a large central battery ("Utron accumulator" — Carr: "1,000 2-volt cells inside this one unit," 12,000 V planned for the 45-ft craft), six peripheral *Utrons* on bearings, and six capacitor plates. (2) An outer ring rotating counter-clockwise, carrying twelve horseshoe electromagnets; Utrons pass through their air gaps. (3) A cabin on the central shaft, kept stationary because "when you have rotation in both directions, the cabin itself is like a bearing and extension of the shaft."

The Utron. A bicone ("two ice-cream cones put together at the wide ends," 90° included angle) — "completely round and completely square," which Carr called "the geometric form of space" — with a hollow spherical interior. In Gobbi's reconstruction the cavity holds mercury as a liquid rotor, the outside carries a coil wound "from apex to equator to apex," and fins make it spin like a turbine in the platform's own airflow. Carr: "All energy comes from these two cones... we have put a battery in motion."

The operating claim. Electromagnets pulse in commutated sequence to spin the platform (a brushed motor); above some speed the Utrons passing the electromagnet gaps generate more than they consume ("the generative coils will put back into the batteries... the same amount of volts going out"), the capacitor plates "utilize atmospheric electricity" and glow blue-green, and:

"Any vehicle accelerated to an axis rotation relative to its attractive inertial mass, immediately becomes activated by free-space-energy and acts as an independent force... When the exact counter-rotation matches the forward rotation the body loses its polarity entirely and immediately becomes activated by free-energy (tensor stresses in space)... The above-described assembly of counter-rotating charged masses becomes weightless and will escape the immediate attraction of gravitational forces."

The numbers Carr gave. "Our 45-foot craft has a rotation of 580 rpm and when it reaches this rotation it is totally independent of its inertial attractive mass" — Colton's gloss: 580 rpm on 45 ft is "relatively equal to the earth's rotation speed" (Earth "8,000 miles in diameter rotating once in 24 hours"). And: "This model was spun at 40,000

rpm and when it did it set a pressure pattern of 1,000 tons; the horsepower reading was a little over 700. Six engineers checked this out. Now the relative rotation of this model would be about 68,000 rpm, and when it reaches this rotation, it would immediately take off." (An OTC bulletin of Dec 1957 places the "1,000 tons" in 1952, from a 4-inch model.) **DOCUMENTED** (as statements)

6. Gobbi's 2021 reconstruction

Julio Gobbi's "Carr Technology" (General Science Journal, 30 Jan 2021) is the only attempt to put equations under the description, and it is useful precisely because it commits to numbers. Its chain: the Utron is a mercury Faraday (unipolar) disc; rotation in the coil's field separates charge in the mercury (Lorentz/Hall); the separated current reinforces the coil field (positive feedback); the rotating Utrons project atmospheric charge onto the capacitor plates, which become "superconducting" and generate a central magnetic field that "repulses the vertical component of the terrestrial magnetic field"; counter-rotating masses induce a "gravitational potential" via an "inertial current" $I = \omega^2(r_2^2 - r_1^2)/2$. Headline outputs: $B \approx 1.4 \times 10^5$ T inside a 1-m Utron; $\approx 10^9$ T on the craft axis; 5×10^{13} W available per coil; 1.6×10^6 kg levitated magnetically; 25 t neutralised at 4×10^4 rpm; an "artificial gravity" of 45 m/s^2 four metres above the deck. It contains no experiment and no measurement; its sources are the Camelot page and the rexresearch transcripts. Its citation dates for *FATE* ("May 1995," "August 1995") are the 1958 and 1959 items misdated. Priced in §§8–9. **SINGLE-SOURCE** (theory only)

PART III — THE PHYSICS, PRICED

7. The one number that decodes

Start with the number everyone quotes and nobody checks. "580 rpm for a 45-ft craft equals the Earth's rotation" is dimensionally meaningless as angular velocity (Earth: 7.3×10^{-5} rad/s; 580 rpm: 60.7 rad/s). But Colton's "one mile in diameter would be 8,000 turns in 24 hours" is a *circumference* scaling — and it decodes: he is matching the craft's **rim linear speed** to Earth's equatorial surface speed.

45 ft $\rightarrow$ $r = 6.86$ m. At 580 rpm, $\omega = 60.7$ rad/s, rim speed $v = \omega r = 417$ m/s. Earth's equatorial surface speed is 465 m/s (exact match at 647 rpm — Gobbi's "corrected" 660 rpm is this same arithmetic). So the "580 rpm" is a coherent, if unmotivated, engineering statement: *spin the rim as fast as the ground under it moves.* **DERIVED**

Two things follow immediately.

1. **The premise fails on Earth itself.** Earth's equator *does* move at 465 m/s, and the resulting centrifugal relief is $\omega^2 R = 0.034$ m/s² — **0.35% of g**. Rotation at Earth's surface speed does not make Earth's surface weightless; it makes it 0.35% lighter. The number Carr matched has no relation to lift. **REFUTED**
2. **The hull cannot survive the number.** Hoop stress in a thin spinning ring is $\sigma = \rho v^2$. At 417 m/s: aluminium 6061-T6, 4.7×10^8 Pa against a 2.7×10^8 Pa yield — **1.7 $\times$ past yield**; 4340 steel, 1.4×10^9 vs 1.1×10^9 — **1.2 $\times$ past**; Ti-6Al-4V just survives at 0.87 of yield, before any bending, ports, bearings, or the twelve electromagnets bolted to the rim. And Carr's "relative rotation" doubles it: 1,160 rpm actual on each ring gives 833 m/s (Mach 2.4 rim speed in air) and 1.9×10^9 Pa in aluminium — seven times yield. The 45-ft craft, built as described, disintegrates well before its magic number. **PRICED**

The 40,000-rpm model: on a 4-inch model ($r = 5$ cm) rim speed is 213 m/s and aluminium hoop stress 1.2×10^8 Pa — survivable, so that statement is at least mechanically possible. "A pressure pattern of 1,000 tons" has no referent (pressure is not measured in tons; if it means thrust on a stand it was not observed on 20 April 1959, when the 272-kg prototype sat still under external drive). "Horsepower reading a little over 700" is 522 kW into a hand-sized model — the drive shaft would glow. On the 6-ft prototype the same 40,000 rpm gives a rim at 3.8 km/s (Mach 11) and 4×10^{10} Pa: not a machine, an explosion. **PRICED**

8. The Utron, priced

The Utron reduces, in every reconstruction, to a homopolar (Faraday-disc) generator with a liquid-mercury rotor inside a self-wound coil. That is real physics, so price it with the real formulas.

8.1 What a mercury Faraday disc actually delivers

The open-circuit EMF of a rotating conductor of radius r in axial field B is $V = \frac{1}{2}B\omega r^2$. Gobbi's own worked case — $r = 0.10$ m, $B = 1.25$ T (a neodymium surface field), 12,000 rpm ($\omega = 1,257$ rad/s) — gives **$V = 7.9$ volts**. Homopolar machines are low-voltage, high-current devices by construction (which is why every real one — from Faraday's 1831 disc to the 500 MJ Canberra machine — uses brushes or liquid metal contacts and lives at a few volts). There is nothing in a bicone that changes this. Gobbi's derivation of "12,000 V" from a Utron passing through a transformer gap is a separate, and separately broken, calculation (§8.4). **DERIVED**

8.2 The 10^{11} -ampere step

Gobbi's large numbers all originate in one move: taking *every conduction electron in the mercury* ($n = 4.08 \times 10^{28}$ m⁻³) as circulating current at the rotation frequency: $I = n \cdot e \cdot V \cdot f = 1.1 \times 10^{11}$ A for a 1-m Utron, hence $H = 1.1 \times 10^{11}$ A/m and **$B = 1.4 \times 10^5$ T**. But conduction electrons in a rotating metal rotate *with the lattice*; they are not a net current unless separated from the ions. The separation available from rotation is the Tolman–Stewart / centrifugal effect, potential $V \approx m_e \omega^2 r^2 / 2e = 4.5 \times 10^{-8}$ V at 12,000 rpm and 10 cm — and Gobbi in fact computes the Lorentz-separated charge himself, honestly, and gets 3.1×10^{-6} C and **6.2×10^{-4} A** (his §5.1.2, "a very small electric current"). He then observes that this "would still fall short... by a factor of 10" and proceeds with the all-electrons figure anyway. The gap between the honest number and the used one is **fourteen orders of magnitude**. **REFUTED** (on the paper's own arithmetic)

8.3 What 10^5 T means

Field energy density is $B^2/2\mu_0$. At 1.4×10^5 T that is 7.8×10^{15} J/m³ — a cubic metre of it is **1.9 megatons of TNT**. At Gobbi's on-axis 1.0×10^9 T (§7 of his paper), 4×10^{23} J/m³, ten thousand times the field of a magnetar. The strongest steady laboratory field is 45 T (NHMFL); the strongest pulsed non-destructive, ~ 100 T; destructive single-shot flux compression peaks near 1,200 T and vaporises the coil. The magnetic pressure at 1.4×10^5 T is 7.8×10^{15} Pa — the yield strength of steel is 10^9 . Any Utron carrying such a field would be its own bomb. **PRICED**

8.4 The 5×10^{13} W step

The power figure multiplies a field energy (2.2×10^{10} J) by a passage frequency (2,400 Hz), treating the magnetic energy as *delivered* every time a Utron passes a gap. Field energy is not consumed by passing a coil; a generator delivers only the work done *against* the induced current by whatever spins the rotor — here, the platform's own motor. As drawn, the construction is a regenerative loop (battery → electromagnets → platform → Utrons → battery) that, *with no reservoir attached*, is a bookkeeping contradiction — not a violation of "known physics" but of the identity that what leaves a closed loop equals what entered it. The honest question, per the box above, is therefore only: what reservoir did Carr attach, and what does it price to? He named two. "Atmospheric electricity" is priced in \$8.5 (picowatts). "Free-space energy" / "tensor stresses in space" is the vacuum sector — which, as a static ground-state floor, cannot be drawn on at all (it is passive; see the opening box) — and Carr in any case specified no coupling to it, no mechanism by which a mercury bicone would rectify it, and never ran the one test that would have shown anything (thermal sign under load; his single public run was externally motored). So the verdict is not "forbidden": it is *reservoir named, coupling unspecified, signature never sought* — and, for a company, that distinction matters, because it tells you what a real test would have looked like.

UNPRICED (vacuum reservoir) / **PRICED** (atmospheric, \$8.5)

8.5 Atmospheric electricity, priced

Fair-weather field ~ 100 V/m, fair-weather current density $\sim 2 \times 10^{-12}$ A/m². Over Gobbi's 150 m² of capacitor plate that is 3×10^{-10} A — thirty picowatts at 100 V. Gobbi's model instead assigns the atmosphere an electron density of 4×10^{25} m⁻³, which is larger than the density of air *molecules* (2.5×10^{25} m⁻³) and $\sim 10^{16}$ times the actual fair-weather ion density ($\sim 10^9$ m⁻³). Every downstream number (9.7×10^{10} C/s onto the plates, plates going "superconducting" by "structural change in their atoms," the 1.6×10^6 kg magnetically levitated against Earth's 5×10^{-5} T field) inherits that factor.

REFUTED

8.6 The mercury shell

Gobbi's 1-m Utron at 12,000 rpm carries mercury (13,580 kg/m³) at $r = 0.4$ m: centrifugal pressure $\rho\omega^2 r^2/2 = 1.7 \times 10^9$ Pa (**17,000 bar**) against a wall specified as "nylon, celeron, bakelite." Rim speed 628 m/s, Mach 1.8. It bursts. At the 25-cm scale ($r = 0.1$ m, 12,000 rpm) the pressure is 1.1×10^8 Pa (1,100 bar) — still an order past any

plastic and marginal for steel. The 20 April 1959 film shows a plastic housing that "began to come apart from the vibration" and leaked its mercury under a mere external drive motor: the failure mode was demonstrated. **PRICED** / **DOCUMENTED**

9. Counter-rotation and gravity, priced

The mechanism at the centre of Carr's own words is *counter-rotation* — two charged bodies spun oppositely on one axis until "the body loses its polarity entirely" and "becomes weightless." Three independent bounds close this.

1. **Zero net angular momentum is the ordinary case, not an exotic one.** Two equal counter-rotating rotors have $L_{\text{total}} = 0$; that is every coaxial helicopter, every counter-rotating propeller, every reaction wheel pair. Nothing about the state is anomalous, and it is realised a million times a day. **DERIVED**
2. **Spinning masses do not lose weight, to high precision.** The one serious claim that they do — Hayasaka & Takeuchi (PRL 63:2701, 1989), ~ 10 mg loss on a right-spinning gyroscope — was refuted within a year by three independent groups: Faller et al. (PRL 64:825, 1990), Nitschke & Wilmarth (PRL 64:2115, 1990), Quinn & Picard (Nature 343:732, 1990), the last at a sensitivity $\sim 30\times$ below the claimed effect. Rotating-mass weight anomalies are bounded at the 10^{-7} level of the mass. Counter-rotating them adds a symmetry, not an effect. **NULL** (published record)
3. **The framework this lane uses predicts zero for symmetric drives by construction** (companion field guide, Claim 5: "symmetric drives give zero"). Carr's core configuration — matched counter-rotation, "the exact counter-rotation matches the forward rotation" — is precisely the symmetric case. On the lane's own physics, the moment the machine reaches its design condition is the moment any coupling would cancel. **DERIVED**

Gobbi's "gravitoinertial" section introduces a "gravitational permeability of vacuum $\gamma_0 = 1.19 \times 10^9 \text{ kg}^2 \text{ N}^{-1} \text{ m}^{-2}$ " and an "inertial current" $I = \omega^2(r_2^2 - r_1^2)/2$ with units of gravitational potential; from these he obtains 25 t neutralised at 40,500 rpm on a 15-m ring (rim speed 32 km/s — nearly Earth's orbital velocity, and 3.5×10^5 g at the rim), and an "artificial gravity" of 45 m/s^2 four metres above the deck from six 200-kg Utrons at 24,000 rpm on 4-m arms (rim speed 10 km/s, Mach 29, 2.6×10^6 g). These quantities

are not in any physics; the numbers they generate would shred the craft by ten decades before any gravitational effect could be sought. **REFUTED**

10. The "metal turned to Jell-O"

Ring's most vivid claim — that at speed "the metal turned to Jell-o; you could push your finger right into it... as if it was not entirely here in this reality" — is repeated by Gobbi as the plates and hull "becoming superconducting due to the structural change in their atoms," which is then made load-bearing for the $\times 1,000$ field amplification. There is no mechanism offered, no analogue in condensed matter (superconductors are not soft; a type-II superconductor is the same solid it was above T_c), and no test proposed by which it could be checked. It is unfalsifiable as stated and therefore carries no weight either way. **LEGEND**

11. What survives — the residues

The anti-reflex rule requires listing what is *real* in the vicinity, so the next reader does not have to rediscover it.

1. **Liquid-metal homopolar machines are real** and useful: NaK-brush homopolar generators (the Canberra 500 MJ machine, US Navy railgun pulsed-power work) exist because liquid-metal contacts carry the mega-amp currents a few volts demand. Mercury as a rotor is Faraday's own 1821–31 choice. None of this is a source of energy; all of it converts shaft work to electricity at a few volts. **RESIDUE** (engineering, not propulsion)
2. **Self-excited dynamo action in a rotating conductor is real** — Gobbi's "positive feedback" has a lawful cousin. Riga (2000) and Karlsruhe (1999) achieved it in liquid sodium; the threshold is a magnetic Reynolds number $R_m = \mu_0 \sigma v L$ of order 10–100 for optimised flows and several hundred for unconstrained spherical Couette flow (Madison and Grenoble sodium spheres did not self-excite at $R_m \sim 100$ –200). A 25-cm mercury Utron at 12,000 rpm has $R_m \approx 10$ ($\sigma_{\text{Hg}} = 1.04 \times 10^6$ S/m, $v \approx 78$ m/s, $L = 0.1$ m) — *one to two orders short*, not fourteen; a 1-m mercury Utron at 12,000 rpm would reach $R_m \approx 260$, but its wall is at 17,000 bar (§8.6). And a dynamo is a *load*: field growth is paid by increased drag on the drive, exactly as in every generator. So the honest version of "the Utron reinforces

its own field" is: *possible in principle in a sodium sphere the size of a room, sourced by a motor, producing a field measured in gauss.* **RESIDUE** (interesting physics, wrong claim)

3. **Counter-rotating coaxial rotors** are the correct architecture for a torque-neutral disc-shaped drone — for the ordinary reason (§9.1). The companion vehicle paper (*The Hexalock*) already assumes it. Carr's geometry is not evidence for that choice, but it is not against it either. **RESIDUE** (aerodynamics)
4. **The rim-speed decode (§7)** is worth recording as a methodological point: the fringe number was not random; it encoded a specific (wrong) physical intuition — "match the ground's speed." Finding the intuition is how one prices a claim instead of dismissing it, and it is also how one sees exactly where it fails (0.35% of g).

12. Scorecard

Claim	Status	Receipt / reason
Carr met Tesla; Tesla was his source	LEGEND	Self-contradicted on air (28 Jun 1958); hotel anachronism; three incompatible dates; no document.
US 2,912,244 is a disguised spacecraft schematic	LEGEND	Patent text: "amusement device simulating a space ride"; nine claims, all ride mechanics; Carr himself used it as PR.
A prototype flew (6-ft, 1959)	REFUTED	Bench test 20 Apr 1959, external motor, mercury leak, housing came apart (WKY-TV film, NBC report).
A 45-ft craft flew ten miles with three crew (Ring)	LEGEND	Only 45-ft article was the Frontier City ride; single witness, 45 years later, contradictory retellings, no second witness, no replication.
Lab raided and files seized by government (1961)	LEGEND	Absent from press/SEC/court/FBI record; Carr was serving a fine in Oklahoma.
Carr was persecuted / sentenced to 14 years	REFUTED	\$5,000 fine (statutory max), no prison term; ~6 months in lieu; SEC civil injunction; NY AG subpoena. Public trial and published appeal.

580 rpm on 45 ft "equals Earth's rotation" → weightless	REFUTED	Decodes as rim speed ≈ 465 m/s; Earth's own centrifugal relief at that speed is 0.35% of g; hull is $1.7\times$ past yield (Al).
Utron = mercury homopolar generator	DERIVED	Fair reconstruction; delivers ~ 8 V at 1.25 T, 12,000 rpm, $r = 10$ cm.
Utron field 10^5 – 10^9 T; 10^{13} W; 10^6 kg levitated (Gobbi)	REFUTED	All-electron current error ($10^{14}\times$ over the paper's own Hall estimate); field energy 1.9 Mt/m ³ ; atmosphere ion density $10^{16}\times$ over.
Regenerative loop runs itself	PRICED	First-principles test, not prohibition: reservoir "atmospheric electricity" prices to 3×10^{-10} A on 150 m ² ; reservoir "free-space energy" (the vacuum's zero-point floor — passive, so zero for any static device) named with no coupling, no mechanism, no thermal-sign test; only public run externally motored.
Counter-rotation cancels weight	NULL	Gyroscope-weight nulls 1990 (Faller; Nitschke; Quinn & Picard); framework predicts zero for symmetric drives.
Metal becomes soft/superconducting at speed	LEGEND	No mechanism, no analogue, no test.
Self-excited dynamo in a rotating liquid-metal sphere	RESIDUE	Real (Riga/Karlsruhe, sodium); mercury Utron 1–2 decades short in Rm and mechanically impossible at the size that closes it; a load, not a source.
Coaxial counter-rotation for a disc drone	RESIDUE	Correct for torque balance; ordinary reasons; see <i>Hexalock</i> .

13. What a drone company should take from Carr

- Nothing to build.** There is no configuration in the OTC-X1 that survives its own numbers long enough to be a bench item; the mercury Utron is a homopolar generator with a burst hazard.
- Two failure signatures worth recognising**, because they recur in this literature: the *demo that is postponed at the hour* (inventor unavailable; a "one-sixteenth-inch"

bearing) and the *number that inflates under scrutiny* (1,000 tons in 1952 from a 4-inch model → 45-ft craft at \$20 million). The companion field guide records the mirror signature — the claimed force that *shrinks* 40× under instrumentation (Buhler). Both are the same lesson: instrument first, announce second. A company that publishes its balance, its five controls and its nulls becomes the credible instrument this field has never had.

3. **If you want to test a Utron-class energy claim, test the reservoir, not the loop.** The three questions in the opening box are the whole protocol: name it, price it, read the thermometer under load. A liquid-metal homopolar rotor that ran *cold* while delivering net output would be a result; one that runs warm is a motor with extra steps. Nobody has ever run that test on this geometry — which is the one honest "open" left in the file.
4. **Do not import the mystique with the geometry.** Bicones, counter-rotation, and liquid-metal rotors are all legitimate objects; none of them acquires new physics by being arranged as Carr arranged them. The lane's rotating-mass thread that is worth a bench date is Wallace's (nuclear-spin-selected rotors, unreplicated, no published null) — see the field guide §8 — not Carr's.
5. **The rim-speed lesson.** Any disc-craft concept should have its rim speed and hoop stress computed on the first page. Carr's design condition was Mach 1.2 at the rim on a rotor carrying twelve electromagnets; Gobbi's is Mach 29. A one-line check would have priced both.

References & receipts

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- Rotating-mass nulls: Hayasaka & Takeuchi, PRL 63, 2701 (1989); Faller et al., PRL 64, 825 (1990); Nitschke & Wilmarth, PRL 64, 2115 (1990); Quinn & Picard, *Nature* 343, 732 (1990).
- Dynamo experiments: Gailitis et al., PRL 84, 4365 (2000) (Riga); Stieglitz & Müller, *Phys. Fluids* 13, 561 (2001) (Karlsruhe); Madison Dynamo Experiment and DTS Grenoble reports (no self-excitation at $R_m \sim 100\text{--}200$).
- Arithmetic in this paper (§§7–9): rim speed $v = \omega r$; hoop stress $\sigma = \rho v^2$; Faraday-disc EMF $\frac{1}{2}B\omega r^2$; Tolman–Stewart potential $m_e\omega^2 r^2/2e$; $R_m = \mu_0\sigma v L$; field energy $B^2/2\mu_0$; centrifugal pressure $\rho\omega^2 r^2/2$. Material data: Al 6061-T6 σ_y 270 MPa; 4340 steel 1.1 GPa; Ti-6Al-4V 880 MPa; ρ_{Hg} 13,580 kg/m³; σ_{Hg} 1.04×10^6 S/m; fair-weather $J \approx 2$ pA/m².

Changelog

- **2026-08-18** — v1.0. Written from the Gobbi 2021 paper (supplied), the patent, the Oklahoma court record, the Collins/Moody documentary work, and the Camelot/rexresearch transcripts. Documentary timeline, patent reading, Tesla and

Ring audits, faithful architecture description, and the priced physics audit (rim-speed decode; hoop stress; homopolar EMF; 14-decade current error; field-energy and magnetic-pressure bounds; atmospheric-supply bound; mercury burst pressure; gyroscope-weight nulls; dynamo Rm residue). Scorecard and drone-company takeaways.

- **2026-08-18** — v1.1 (same day, operator correction): energy claims re-registered from "forbidden as closed loop" to the project's first-principles reservoir test (name / price / thermal sign) — new opening box, §8.4 rewritten, scorecard row and §13 updated. No number changed; the Utron's energy claim is now *unpriced-and-unshown* on the vacuum reservoir and *priced* on the atmospheric one, which is both weaker and more useful than a prohibition.
- **2026-09-23** — v1.2: the vacuum reservoir re-priced. The zero-point floor is passive, not a reservoir (fluctuation–dissipation; Puthoff 1987), so "free-space energy" prices to zero for a static device; opening box, §8.4 and the scorecard row updated. The Utron's verdict is unchanged.